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Easy Sheet-Pan Dinners: One Pan, Almost No Cleanup | Trillion Man Outreach

Easy Weeknight Dinner Recipes

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Easy Sheet-Pan Dinners: One Pan, Almost No Cleanup

By the Trillion Man Outreach kitchen crew Updated October 8, 2026

Sheet-pan dinners are the closest thing to a weeknight cheat code. Everything cooks together, the oven does the work and a layer of foil means there is nothing to scrub afterward. Here is the simple formula, the timing rules that keep everything from burning or going soggy, and five combinations to start with.

The sheet-pan formula

Pick one protein, one or two vegetables and a starch. Toss with oil, salt and a seasoning, spread in a single layer and roast at 425 F. That is the whole method.

Protein:
fully cooked sausage, chicken thighs or strips, shrimp, salmon, tofu or chickpeas.

Vegetables:
broccoli, bell peppers, zucchini, green beans, carrots, brussels sprouts.

Starch:
baby potatoes, sweet potato cubes, or serve everything over rice, tortillas or pasta.

Flavor:
garlic powder, taco seasoning, Italian seasoning, smoked paprika or a spoonful of pesto after roasting.

Timing rules that prevent soggy or burnt food

Start slow foods first.
Potatoes need about 10 minutes of head start before broccoli and sausage go on.

Cut to match.
Small pieces cook faster. Cut dense vegetables smaller than soft ones.

Do not crowd the pan.
Crowded food steams instead of roasts. Use two pans if needed.

Line with foil.
It saves cleanup. For extra browning, preheat the pan.

Check doneness.
Chicken should reach 165 F. Check the
USDA temperature chart

for other proteins.

Five easy combinations

1. Sausage, potatoes and broccoli

Our go-to. Roast halved baby potatoes 10 minutes, then add broccoli and sliced cooked sausage for 15 to 20 more minutes. The
full recipe is on our main page
.

2. Chicken fajitas

Toss chicken strips, sliced peppers and onion with oil and fajita seasoning. Roast 20 to 25 minutes until the chicken hits 165 F. Serve in warm tortillas.

3. Salmon, green beans and lemon

Roast green beans 8 minutes, add salmon fillets and roast until the fish reaches 145 F and flakes easily, about 10 to 12 minutes.

4. Chickpea and sweet potato tray

Roast sweet potato cubes with drained, dried chickpeas, cumin and paprika for 25 to 30 minutes. Finish with a drizzle of yogurt or tahini. A great meatless night.

5. Italian meatball tray

Arrange frozen, fully cooked meatballs with zucchini and cherry tomatoes. Roast about 20 minutes, then top with mozzarella for the last few minutes.

Make it a system

Keep the ingredients for one sheet-pan meal on hand and rotate the seasoning. It pairs well with a
weekly meal plan
and works for
nights with no energy
. Leftover roasted vegetables turn into tomorrow’s quesadillas or fried rice.

Let us take dinner off your plate

The Rescue Kit picks dinner by how tired you are. The Cheap Dinner Vault shows what each dinner costs.

Get the Rescue Kit

Get the Cheap Dinner Vault

Questions, answered

What temperature is best for sheet-pan dinners?

425 F works for most combinations because it browns vegetables without drying out the

protein. Delicate fish can go slightly lower.

How do I keep vegetables from getting soggy?

Use a single layer, dry the vegetables well, give them enough oil and avoid crowding the pan.

Explore every dinner guide

Keep building your weeknight plan with these related guides. Each one covers a different part of getting dinner on the table.

5-Ingredient Dinners: Short Grocery List, Real Dinner

Simple dinners with five ingredients or fewer.

Cheap Family Dinners With the Cost Per Serving

Learn to estimate cost per serving and stretch a grocery budget.

Easy Dinner Ideas for When You Have No Energy

Low-effort ideas for exhausted nights.

Freezer Meals for Busy Weeknights

Make-ahead dinner ideas, freezing tips and safe thawing guidance.

Leftover Chicken Recipes

Turn leftover chicken into several easy dinners.

Pantry Staples List for Budget Cooking

Build a practical pantry for affordable meals and less food waste.

Picky-Eater Dinner Ideas That the Whole Table Will Eat

Low-pressure family dinner ideas and practical strategies.

Slow Cooker Dinners for Busy Families

Hands-off slow cooker meals, timing tips and safe food handling.

Weekly Meal Plan for Busy Families

A seven-night dinner plan and shopping list.

Make tomorrow's dinner even easier.

Your free resource is yours to keep. If you'd like more help, these optional tools make real-life meal planning easier.

DINNER PLANNING MADE SIMPLE

The 5:47 P.M. Rescue Kit

Find low-effort dinners based on how much energy you have, plus useful planning tools for busy evenings.

EXPLORE THE RESCUE KIT

SHOP SMARTER FOR FAMILY MEALS

The Cheap Dinner Vault

Compare low-cost dinner ideas and practical meal-budget approaches to get more from your groceries.

EXPLORE BUDGET DINNERS

Both resources are optional. Your free printable does not require a purchase.

WHAT'S FOR EATS / OPTIONAL DINNER HELP

Love this free resource?

Here's how to make weeknight dinners easier.

Your free guide is yours to keep - no purchase is required.
If you'd like more structured dinner help, explore these optional tools.

THE 5:47 P.M. RESCUE KIT

A practical dinner-planning shortcut for busy evenings.
Plan simple meals without starting from scratch.

EXPLORE THE RESCUE KIT

Tap the button to view details before purchasing.

THE CHEAP DINNER VAULT

Browse budget-minded dinner tools and meal-planning ideas.
Built for stretching the grocery budget further.

SEE THE CHEAP DINNER VAULT

Tap the button to view details before purchasing.

Free guide first. Paid extras are always optional.

These links may lead to products for sale on our website or partner checkout.